

Remembering Our Heritage

THE FUNK FAMILY CONNECTION

The Funk Connections go back to my great grandmother, Elizabeth Funk (1810-1846). Elizabeth and her husband, Peter Wall (1804-1846) were the parents of:

1. Peter Wall (1840-1884) 23 Aug 1840 - 19 Jan 1884
2. Henry Wall (1843-1916)
3. Elizabeth Wall (1845-1922)

We know that the parents of Peter, Henry and Elizabeth both died in 1846, shortly after baby Elizabeth was born. We also know that these three siblings were raised by their Aunts and Uncles and that they left their homes at a very early age.

One family source mentions that she thought the orphans mother's name was "Marta", but that would be inconsistent with family tradition. Other family records show Elizabeth as the mother. This would coincide with the baby daughter being named Elizabeth.

Next we find the following family:

- #60203 Heinrich (Henry) Funk 1822-1879 Married Anna Unruh (1817-1901)
Part of their family is as follows: (1) - their children -
Children of (1) - Henry Funk (1842-0000) Married another Anna Unruh (1842-0000) 1 child Anna H Funk 1878-1964
Peter Funk (1843-1880) Married Henry Wall (1843-1916) 3 children: Anna Funk (1844-0000) Married Jacob J. Duerksen (1840-1904)
Sarah Funk (1845-1917) Married Abraham Duerksen (1843-1886)
Elizabeth Funk (1846-1895) Married Jacob Duerksen (1841-1915)

- (2) David Funk (1848-1922) Married 1st Anna Adrian (0000-1879) 2nd Nettie Voth (1861-1889) 3rd Mary Fast (0000-1935)
399460 1861-1924

It is reported that David Funk owned and operated a flour mill, and that his brother-in-law, Henry Wall (1843-1916) who was a tailor by trade, (did) for him at the mill.

Many legal documents sometimes give false information. For example in my own family. I searched for several years trying to locate my parents marriage records. When they were located I was surprised at the false recordings they had given.

The marriage license and Certificate of Marriage, both dated November 8, 1906 at Carrington, North Dakota, show that they were married by the Foster County Judge in his office. Both mother (Anna Unruh) and my Dad (Henry Wall), stated that their residence was at New Home in Stutsman County. This of course was very untrue. My Dad had just come from California and met mother in Missoula, Montana. Mother lived in Rosthern, Saskatchewan, Canada where she owned a dress making shop and was just in Missoula visiting relatives.

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Mother and Dad ran off together to get married and ended up in Carrington, near where some other relatives were living. Also my dear mother, misstated her age, she reported that she was 22 years of age when in fact she was 24 1/2 years old. (She wanted to be younger than her husband.)

Another example, on the Record of Registration of Death of my mother at the Vital Statistics Office, records show that mother was born on April 22, 1883. This is totally false as mother was born on June 4, 1882 at Parker, Turner County, South Dakota.

SO BE IT

This history account I have put together is to be used only as a guideline only for those who may want to continue on the project. However it must be understood that one must do their own research to confirm history as best as one can.

According to family reports, the Funk girls were in very much demand as wives. They usually were very good looking, healthy, energetic and would have been trained at an early age, the fine arts of cooking, housekeeping and how to be a responsible mother for their children.

A look at 4 Funk sisters

Anna Funk (1843-1880) Married Henry Wall (1843-1916)
Anna Funk was born in the Crimea and this is where she married Henry Wall. They came to America on July 28, 1876. Anna and Henry Wall had a total of 5 children, but Anna died in 1880 while giving birth to the 6th baby named "Eva". The baby also died. See details of this family in the Henry Wall section

Katherina Funk (1844-0000) Married Jacob J. Duerksen (1840-1904)
Katherine and Jacob had 8 children.
(See the House of Dirk section)

Sarah Funk (1845-1917) Married Abraham Duerksen (1843-1886)
Sarah Funk b. Nov 19, 1845 They had 10 children before Abraham Duerksen was killed by lightning.
(See the House of Dirk section)

Elizabeth Funk (1846-1895) Married Jacob Duerksen (1841-1915)
Elizabeth Funk b. Nov 19, 1846 d. May 14, 1895
(See the House of Dirk section)

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Now to a younger David Funk (1848-1922)
David Funk had a total of 15 children between 3 wives.

David Funk (1848-1922) 1st marriage was with Anna Adrian (0000-1879). They had 1 child as follows, with Anna Adrian died giving birth to their first child.

1. Anna Funk (1879-0000) Married Jacob Thiessen (0000-0000)
Anna Funk and Jacob Thiessen had many children including Tillie Siebold who lives in Jamestown, North Dakota.

Jacob Thiessen was a half brother of Henry Vogt who married Elizabeth (Lizzie) Funk. See the Voth section

David Funk lost no time in getting another wife. He married Aganeta (Nettie) Voth (1861-1889), the 10th child of 10 of Jacob Voth and Aganeta Evert. Nettie Voth was a cousin of Mary Voth, my Dad's first wife. (See the Voth sections)

The following children were with Nettie Voth.

2. Nettie Funk (1880-0000) Married John Rau (0000-0000)

3. Elizabeth Funk (1882-0000) 1st marriage to Henry Vogt (0000-0000)
2nd marriage to Durksen (0000-0000)

4. Sarah Funk (1885-0000) a cripple lived with Nettie and John Rau.

5. Young child died of diptheria at New Home, N.D.

6. Young child died of diptheria at New Home, N.D.

7. Young child and mother (Nettie Voth) both died in childbirth.

Now David Funk had to find another wife very quickly.

David Funk 3rd marriage was with Mary (Maria) Fast (0000-1935)

David and Mary had 8 more children together as follows:

8. David Funk (0000-0000) Married Katie Sperling (0000-0000)
<A-1> Harriet Funk (0000- Married Robert Katama (0000-0000)
Harriet lives in Ceres, California.
Robert lives in Modesto, California.

9. Henry Funk (0000- Married Edna (0000-0000)
Edna lives in a residential care unit near Grants Pass, Oregon.
I believe they had 2 children.

10. Maggie Funk (0000- Married John Sperling (0000- both died
<A-1> Lawrence Sperling (0000- also deceased.

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11. Mary Funk (0000- Married Huenergardt (0000-0000)
<A-1> Elinor Huenergardt (0000-0000) Married Brown (0000-0000)
Elinor died from wounds received from a bull that gored her.

- <A-2> Betty Huenergardt (0000-0000)

- <A-3> Edmond Huenergardt (0000-0000)

- <A-4> Wilber Huenergardt (0000-0000 killed in accident.

- <A-5> Virgil Huenergardt (0000-0000)

12. Alma Funk (0000-0000) Married Julius Kurtz (0000-0000)
<A-1> Wilma Kurtz (0000-0000 lives in Bakersfield, California.

13. Alice Funk (0000-0000) Married Elmer Biloff (0000-0000)
Alice Funk died and Elmer Biloff then married Helen (0000-0000)
They live in Shafter, California.

- <A-1> Arli Biloff (0000-0000 lives in Shafter, California.

- <A-2> Janet Biloff (0000-0000)

14. Ervin Funk (1901- Married Wayne Wentland (0000-0000)
<A-1> Dellia Wentland (0000-0000 lives in Carrington, N.D.

15. Ervin Funk (1910-1998) Married Marie Kruschwitz (0000-1975)

Marie Kruschwitz died in 1975, then on January 8, 1977, Ervin married my cousin, Ellen (Kurtz) Jacobson, daughter of Margaret Wall and Daniel Kurtz. Ervin passed away on February 14, 1998 at Concord, California and was buried in Shafter beside his first wife, Marie.

Ervin and Marie have 2 children as follows:

- <A-1> Arlo Funk (0000- Married Juanita (0000-0000)
They live in Battleground, Washington.

- <A-2> Janet Funk (0000-0000)

More of the Funk Family to sort out

John F. Funk (1835-1930)

Abram F. Funk (0000-0000)
John and Abram were brothers. John F. Funk founded the Elkhart Mennonite church in 1871 also had a large building in Elkhart, Indiana about 1872

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Joseph Funk (0000-0000)
Joseph Funk and son advertized Genuine church music in 1876

Kornelius Funk (1856-1928) Married Anna Unruh (1854-1906)

<A-1> Heinrich Funk (0000-0000) married Anna Duerksen (0000-0000)
Heinrich Funk died in Jail, Anna Duerksen's neice was Elizabeth Duerksen (0000-0000) the 4th child of 7 of Jacob G. Duerksen (1860-1922) and Elizabeth Dickmann. (See the House of Dirk)

Elizabeth Duerksen married Heinrich P. Funk (0000-0000)
Heinrich P. Funk and Elizabeth Duerksen lived in East Chilliwick, B.C. and I believe their children all live in Canada. To my knowledge their 6 children are as follows:

1. Henry Funk (0000- Lab work

2. Frieda Funk (0000- m. Herman Ratzlaff (0000-0000)

3. Edward Funk (0000-0000)

4. Otto Funk (0000-0000)

5. Frau Funk (0000-0000)

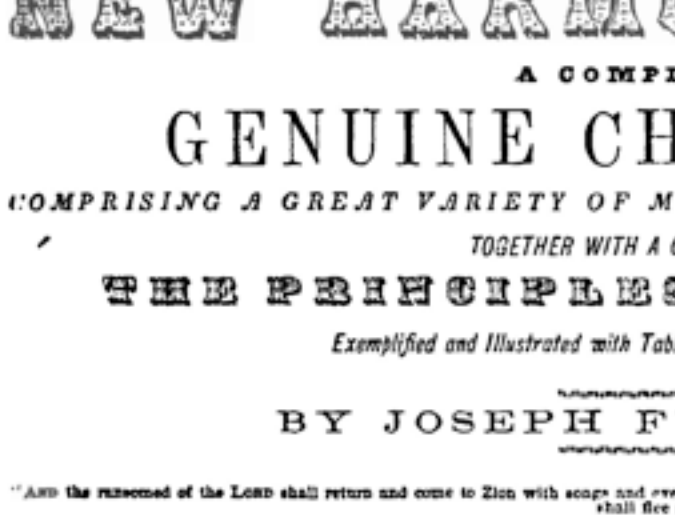
6. Peter Funk (0000- was a student at Tabor College

Jacob Funk (1877-1909) emigrated in 1875 was a Rev. minister of Brutherthal

Justina Funk (0000-0000) Married Peter Duerksen (1887-0000)
(they remained in Russia we are told?)

Peter Duerksen was the 6th child of 9 of Gerhard Duerksen (1814-1910) and Anna Doerksen (1817-1881) who pulled and pushed their baby carriage all the way from Prussia to Russia. (See the House of Dirk section for more details).

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The Mennonite Publishing Company, Elkhart, Ind., staff of workers. In front row seated: Second from left, John S. Coffman; next, Henry Breneman; next, Joseph Summers; next, Abram Funk; next, John F. Funk; and last in row, A.C. Kolb, editor of Herald of Truth. Boy in front is S.F. Coffman, son of John S. Coffman, who served as printer's errand boy.



The old Prairie Street frame meetinghouse. John F. Funk founded the Elkhart Mennonite congregation in 1871.

THE NEW HARMONIA SACRA. A COMPILATION OF GENUINE CHURCH MUSIC, COMPRISING A GREAT VARIETY OF METRES, HARMONIZED FOR FOUR VOICES. TOGETHER WITH A COPIOUS EXPLANATION OF THE PRINCIPLES OF VOCAL MUSIC, Exemplified and Illustrated with Tables, in a Plain and Comprehensive Manner. BY JOSEPH FUNK AND SONS.

"And the redeemed of the Lord shall return and come to Zion with songs and everlasting joy upon their heads; they shall obtain joy and gladness, and sorrow and sighing shall flee away." - ISAIAH.

FIFTEENTH EDITION.

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